

Slide	Notes
C O D E Lesson 12: AI's Role in Society Problem Solving with AI	
Warm Up	Warm Up (10 mins)
Problem Solving with AI AI's Role in Society – Warm Up Scenario <i>Newsclues.com</i> is a website that displays articles written by journalists from various news outlets. The site currently has a team of 10 people who choose which articles to feature. They are deciding to replace this team with an AI-powered news filtering system.	■ Goal of this activity: Have students practice weighing pros and cons of an AI-powered system. ■ ■ Do This: Introduce the scenario about Newsclues.com, a fictional website that is deciding to replace the people who pick the articles to feature on the site with an AI-powered news filtering system.
Problem Solving with AI AI's Role in Society – Warm Up Discuss: - What are the risks of using an AI-system to decide which news articles to feature? - Who is impacted most by AI errors, such as linking to unverified or inaccurate sources? - Who is impacted most by AI bias, such as linking to articles that present only one perspective on an issue?	■ Discuss: Have students write a one-minute response to the discussion prompts about the scenario from the previous slide. Then, have them pair up and take turns summarizing their writing in one minute. What are the risks of using an AI-system to decide which news articles to feature? Who is impacted most by AI errors, such as linking to unverified or inaccurate sources? Who is impacted most by AI bias, such as linking to articles that present only one perspective on an issue? ■ Discussion Goal: The goal of this discussion is to help students critically evaluate the benefits and risks of AI decision-making in media curation. This discussion will set the stage for deeper exploration of AI's role in their own communities. Here are things to listen for: AI is not neutral; it reflects biases in training data. AI may favor certain perspectives while excluding others. Risk of misinformation (e.g., promoting unreliable sources). AI may prioritize engagement over accuracy. Benefits: Companies (cost savings), increased efficiency. Harms: Journalists (job loss), misinformation in communities. Teaching Tip Keep these discussions moving along and once you hear the points mentioned in the Discussion Goal, proceed to the next prompt or section of the lesson. If students have more to share than time allows, let them know that they will have a chance to share their voice later in the lesson as part of the main activity where they write an elevator pitch about AI use.

Lesson Objectives

By the end of this lesson, you will be able to . . .

- Evaluate AI's societal impact by investigating its effects on different community groups.
- Assess the environmental costs of AI, including energy consumption and carbon emissions.
- Propose equitable AI solutions to ensure responsible and inclusive implementation.

■ ■ Do This: Introduce the lesson objectives.

Question of the Day

How should AI be used in solving real-world problems?

■ ■ Do This: Introduce the Question of the Day.

Activity (30 mins)

Activity

AI in My Community

You and your partner should have:

- AI in My Community activity guide.
- Pen or pencil



AI in My Community: Helpful or Harmful? (15 mins)

■ Goal of this activity: Help students assess how AI is impacting their own local communities. AI's impact varies by location, economy, and social factors—students should advocate for fair and accessible AI. This part of the activity also focuses on having students use AI to help summarize and draw key points out of source material.

■ ■ Do This: Place students in pairs.

■ Distribute: Give each student a copy of the AI in My Community activity guide.

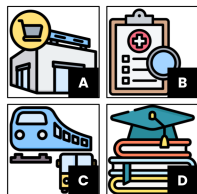
Activity Title

Lesson 12

1

Do This:

1. Go to Lesson 12, Level 1.
2. Pick the area you'd like to focus on.
3. Read the headline and first sentence of each article in the folder you are sent to.



■ ■ Do This: Direct students to Lesson 12, Level 1. Students choose one implementation of AI to focus on. For all of the choices, students will be sent to a folder with four articles – one feature article about the use of AI they picked, one editorial on the use of AI they picked, one tabloid-style article about the area they picked, and one feature article focused on environmental issues.

Teaching Tip

Note: These articles were written by Code.org staff members. The articles were crafted along with ChatGPT, which was used to synthesizing around 20 different news articles on the respective subjects. The facts presented in the articles all come from one or more of these news sources.

You may choose to tailor this list to issues you know are relevant in your students community if you have sources they can use to learn about these issues.

Activity Title

Lesson 12



Do This:

1. Go to Lesson 12, Level 2.
2. Pick the same option that you chose on Level 1.
3. Use AI Chat to help you summarize articles. Try different combinations of articles, and record your findings.



■ Do This: Direct students to Lesson 12, Level 2. Students choose the same implementation they picked in the previous level and then use AI Chat to summarize the articles and pull out key information. They should record their findings in their activity guide.

■ Circulate: Listen for students making local connections to their own school or city and asking follow-up questions to the AI when summaries are incomplete. If students finish too fast or seem stuck:

"How would someone in your neighborhood feel about this?"

"How could this tech be made more fair or eco-friendly?"

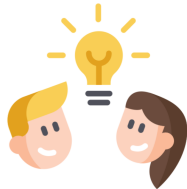
Check Your Understanding

Lesson 12



Do This:

1. Go to Lesson 12, Level 2.
2. Answer the reflection questions about the impacts AI has.



■ Say: You've explored how AI is affecting different parts of your community—now let's shift into reflecting and connecting ideas. Think about the biggest impacts you noticed, any concerns that stood out to you, and what questions you still have about AI's role in society.

■ Do This: Direct students to Lesson 12, Level 3 to complete the formative assessment.

Assessment Opportunity

This reflection will help you gauge how well students understand AI's impact on communities and the environment, and whether they're thinking critically about equity. Pay attention to the following:

Community awareness: Are students identifying both positive and negative impacts of AI on different groups in their community (e.g., age, income, ability, race, location)?

Environmental understanding: Do students recognize specific environmental concerns like AI's energy use, reliance on data centers, or carbon emissions?

Curiosity and gaps: Are student questions thoughtful and relevant, revealing areas where they want to dig deeper—or misunderstandings that need clarification?

Actions to take:

If students focus too narrowly (e.g., one group or only benefits), prompt them with: "How might this affect someone with different needs or background?" or pair students to challenge each other's perspectives.

If students skip environmental concerns, briefly review how AI depends on large-scale computing and power use. Encourage connections to articles or earlier class discussions.

If student questions reveal confusion or patterns of misunderstanding, group similar ones and address them in a brief discussion or mini-lesson to clarify before moving on.

Do This:

Part 2: Brainstorm a Change

- Think about what you learned from your research
- Brainstorm one idea that could make AI more fair, more effective, or less harmful
- It can be a small change or a big one — just something that responds to what you found

■ Do This: Tell students to turn to Part 2 of their activity guide. Explain that this is their chance to reflect on everything they've learned so far and come up with one change or improvement that could make AI more fair, more effective, or less harmful — especially for people in their community. Emphasize that it can be a small, practical idea or a bigger, more visionary one. If students are stuck, encourage them to think about who benefits or is left out in their topic, and what could be done differently to improve that.

■ Circulate: As students brainstorm an idea, encourage them to focus on the core problem or concern they uncovered in their research. Ask questions like: What's something you think should be done differently with this technology?, Who is being left out or harmed in the way this AI is currently used?, or What would make this system more fair or useful for your school or neighborhood? Support students in thinking practically and specifically — their ideas don't need to be perfect or large-scale, just thoughtful and connected to what they learned.

Video: UNICEF Youth Advocate Ayshka on Mental Health

- Can you identify the different parts of the pitch — like the hook, the main idea, and the call to action?
- What makes the message feel personal and effective?



Share Your Voice (15 mins)

■ Say: We've spent time learning about how AI affects different parts of our community — and you've started thinking about a change you'd like to see. Now we're going to watch a short video from a youth advocate who shares their message about an issue that matters to them. As you watch, see if you can identify the parts of their message that make it powerful — especially the hook, the main idea, and the call to action. These are the same pieces you'll use in your own elevator pitch.

Teaching Tip

Let students know this example is a little longer and more reflective than a typical elevator pitch. For their own pitch, they should aim to keep it short, clear, and direct — something they could realistically say in 30 seconds or less.

■ Video: Show the "UNICEF Youth Advocate Ayshka on Mental Health" video.

Questions to consider with the video:

Can you identify the different parts of the pitch — like the hook, the main idea, and the call to action?

What makes the message feel personal and effective?

Discussion Goal: Students begin to recognize the key elements of an effective elevator pitch — including a strong hook, a clear main message, and a compelling call to action. They also notice how personal experience, emotion, and audience awareness can make a short message more powerful and memorable.

Do This:

Part 3: Share What You Discovered

- Choose your audience — Who should hear your idea?
- Plan and write your pitch — use the elevator pitch guide on page 3
- *Optional: Use AI Chat to support your work*
 - Be the pilot: Write your pitch, then ask AI to help revise it
 - Be the co-pilot: Ask AI to write a draft, then improve it yourself

■ Do This: Explain that students are now moving on to Part 3 of their activity guide, where they'll turn their ideas into a clear message they can share with others. First, they'll choose an audience that would benefit from or care about what they've learned. Then, they'll write a short elevator pitch using the guide on page 3. Students can collaborate with AI — by revising their own draft with AI's help or improving a draft written by AI. Encourage students to think about what kind of message would connect with their audience — should it sound formal or casual? Informative or persuasive?

■ Circulate: As students work, look for them making connections between their pitch and what they learned in Part 1. If they're unsure how to start, remind them they can begin with the hook and write one sentence at a time. Prompt them to use vocabulary like "equity," "access," "impact," or "responsibility" if relevant.

Optional: Collaborate with AI

Lesson 12



Do This (if you choose to use AI):

1. Go to Lesson 12, Level 4.
2. Work with the AI to either:
 - Help you revise your own elevator pitch
 - Or generate a draft that you can improve



■ Transition: Let students know that if they want help drafting or refining their elevator pitch, they can go to Level 4 to use AI Chat. They can choose to be the pilot (write it themselves and ask AI to revise) or the co-pilot (ask AI to draft and then improve it). Using AI is optional — students can also write and revise on their own if they prefer.

Teaching Tip

Some students might benefit from using AI to help them with tone or structure, especially if they're stuck. Others may prefer to write on their own. Either approach is okay — the goal is to clearly communicate their idea to the audience they chose.



Give One, Get One!

Do This: Share your elevator pitch with your peers.

- **Give** your elevator pitch.
- **Get** an elevator pitch.

Find another classmate and repeat!



■ ■ Do This: Explain that students will participate in a “Give One, Get One” elevator pitch exchange. They will find a partner and take turns sharing their elevator pitches — one person gives their pitch, the other listens and gives quick feedback or asks a question. Then they switch roles. After both students have shared, they'll find a new partner and repeat. Encourage students to share with multiple classmates to hear a variety of perspectives and practice tailoring their pitch to different audiences.

■ ■ Do This: Play the music clip to signal the start of the activity. Use the same music cue consistently so students recognize when it's time to begin “Give One, Get One.”

■ Circulate: As students share their elevator pitches, listen for how clearly they're communicating their main idea and call to action. Offer support to students who may be stuck or rushing through their pitch. Prompt partners with questions like:

“What did you find most interesting about your partner's idea?”

“Was anything unclear or missing?”

“Did their pitch include a strong hook and a clear call to action?”

Teaching Tip

Give One, Get One encourages students to seek and share ideas and information. When prompted by the teacher, students circulate the classroom and pair up with a partner. Each student “gives” or shares one of their ideas as the other student “gets” or listens and writes it down. The teacher then prompts students to find new partners and repeat the process.

Using music to cue transitions helps create routines in the classroom. When students hear cues, they know it is time to transition to a specific activity. Emphasize to students what the music clip means and be consistent with using the music clip to cue the activity. Click the blue play icon on the slide to play the music cue.

Wrap Up

Wrap Up (5 mins)

Today, you learned about . . .

- AI's societal impact by investigating its effects on different community groups.
- The environmental costs of AI, including energy consumption and carbon emissions.
- AI solutions that ensure responsible and inclusive implementation.

■ ■ Do This: Review the lesson objectives.

Unit Guide

You should have:

- Problem Solving with AI Unit Guide
- pen or pencil



■ ■ Do This: Have students take out their Problem Solving with AI Unit Guide.

Question of the Day

How should AI be used in solving real-world problems?

[Unit Guide](#)

■ ■ Do This: Review the Question of the Day.

✓ Do This:

1. Take turns answering the Question of the Day in one or two sentences.
2. Then "pass the mic" so that everyone in your group has a chance to share.



■ ■ Do This: Have students form small groups of three or four.

■ ■ Do This: Explain that now that they have reflected in their Unit Guide, they will share key takeaways with their group. Explain that the "Pass the Mic" discussion is designed so that everyone gets a chance to share. Each person will share their answer to the Question of the Day in one or two sentences and then "pass the mic" so that everyone has a turn.

■ Circulate: As students share in their groups:

Listen for common themes and misconceptions such as:

Are students clearly identifying AI's strengths and weaknesses?

Are students misunderstanding AI's capabilities (e.g., assuming AI "thinks" like a human)?

Prompt deeper thinking with guiding questions such as:

Did AI ever surprise you with what it could or couldn't do?

Would you trust AI more or less after today's lesson?

Did anyone in your group have a different perspective that made you think differently?

Teaching Tip

If time allows, facilitate a full-class discussion of the QotD. Consider asking students to raise their hands if they heard a new perspective in their group that made them think differently.

If students only state a general opinion (e.g., "AI is good at math"), follow up with: "What makes AI good at that task? Is it better than a human?" or "Can you give an example of when AI would fail at that same task?"

If some students are not engaging in discussion, ask them directly: "What did you write down in your Unit Guide? Can you share one thing that stood out to you?" or "Did you hear something from your group that you agree or disagree with?"